



Introduction to Indigenous Engagement, Relations, and Cultural Awareness

Proven strategies for building trust, consensus, and conflict resolution

Lakehead University

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Introduction to Indigenous Engagement, Relations, and Cultural Awareness

Trainer

Proud member of Bearskin Lake First Nation in Treaty 9, **Garrett Ugray** brings over 10 years of specialized expertise with a track record of success in Indigenous engagement, relations, complex multi-party project management (three or more parties), consensus building, and conflict resolution with the Ministry of Natural Resources and Forestry (MNRF) fulfilling the Crown's Duty to Consult, and the Nuclear Waste Management Organization (NWMO) working as an Indigenous Engagement Associate and later Manager of Nuclear Security and Emergency Preparedness. He was part of an award-winning site selection team that navigated the complex legal and political environment in northwestern Ontario to successfully execute a regional Indigenous engagement strategy to find informed and willing host communities with Ignace and Wabigoon Lake Ojibway Nation to store all of Canada's used nuclear fuel underground in a deep geological repository. Garrett led with a hands-on approach many of the more complex and uncertain engagement files for the NWMO in northwestern Ontario, analyzing and managing legal and political risks, anticipating federal and provincial rulings and legal precedents with proven strategies.

He also has over 20 years of experience as a trainer (forest firefighting, MNRF Aboriginal Relations Trainer, NWMO cultural awareness trainer, nuclear security and emergency preparedness and de-escalation trainer). Garrett is now the founder and principal consultant for Ugray Consulting Ltd., a 100% First Nation-owned strategic Indigenous engagement and relations consulting firm.

Garrett will be interweaving his own lived experiences and key lessons learned as a First Nation person leading various grassroots-level and foundational strategies for Indigenous community relationship building, negotiations, and consensus building strategies throughout the course as appropriate.

Training Methodology

Core Learning Objectives

1. Cultural competency and awareness
2. Trends in industry-Indigenous relations: Crown and Indigenous regulatory and legal frameworks (they each have their own)
3. Practical engagement strategies and examples of varying complexity
4. Industry-Specific Applications

The course is a **safe space to ask questions, communicate challenges, and engage in group discussions free of judgement. This is meant to be an adaptive and positive learning experience for everyone** and to make course participants feel more confident in approaching Indigenous engagement and relationship building with proven strategies.

This supplementary document is meant to accompany the slide deck as it follows along slide by slide, with additional information at the end in Appendix 1 (overview of treaties and Tribal Councils) and 2 (Ministry of Energy and Mines info).

Continuous Improvement

Your feedback is welcomed and encouraged. In the spirit of excellence and continuous improvement, your input helps ensure this workshop remains relevant, practical, and responsive to real-world engagement challenges. By sharing your perspectives, you help refine the materials and contribute to the development of a strong, enduring set of resources that will continue to improve over time.

Please share any feedback to info@ugrayconsulting.com

Introductory Course

Please note that this is an introductory course, and that we are only just scratching the surface of each single topic. To make it accessible, the goal was to keep it to 2 hours, however, the full 3 hours was used.

Slide 1: Title Slide

Comment from Garrett on his home community, Bearskin Lake First Nation's recently created Lands and Resources website, where he found the pictures on the slide and he learned of plans to build all-season roads connecting several of the First Nations up north together and to the Ontario highway system to encourage economic development and the community's hopes to one day entertain mining exploration companies (notable trend worth mentioning).

From the Bearskin Lake community's website:

"The name of the area that the Anishnewac (Oji-Cree for "Indigenous person") first came together to trade, socialized and celebrate was called Bearskin Lake. The Hudson Bay company had established a trading post here and a post office. In the summer of 1932 furious forest fires threatened the northwestern region of Ontario and this would also force the Anishnewac to move east and settle at Michikan Lake some 30 air miles away. The name Michikan is "fish trap" because the people who inhabited this region would block off certain areas of the Michikan River to lure fish into shallow areas and spear or scoop them up for food. The name of the lake they travelled from stuck as the post office could only ship mail to an address at Bearskin Lake."

Ideally, when engaging and working with First Nation communities and people in the mining exploration industry, you're finishing key meetings with handshakes and smiles. Sometimes it doesn't go that way. Sometimes to get to handshakes and smiles all around, there's years of conflict and tension.

Slide 2: Land Acknowledgement & Roundtable Introductions

Garrett's land acknowledgement:

"I acknowledge that we are gathered at Lakehead University on the traditional lands of the Anishinaabe people, and specifically Fort William First Nation, signatories to the Robinson–Superior Treaty of 1850. The Anishinaabe have enjoyed a deep connection to the lands and waters since time immemorial through Indigenous laws, relationships, and responsibilities that continue today. As a First Nation person, I offer this acknowledgement to remind us that Indigenous peoples are not only part of the history of this region but are active Rightsholders and decision-makers in the present. In Northwestern Ontario, activities such as geological prospecting and junior mining exploration continue to take place on Indigenous territories. As we move through this course, I encourage us to think critically about how knowledge, industry, and different institutions engage with Indigenous peoples and what respectful, accountable relationships look like in practice."

Land acknowledgements should be based on your own research on the geographic and treaty area where you are delivering the land acknowledgement: identify the local Indigenous people, the treaty area, and the local community or communities whose traditional territory you're on.

Always a good idea to go to the local First Nation community's website, read about the community, its history, and familiarize yourself with the treaty (doesn't have to be a deep dive). Land acknowledgements can be concise and brief like this example, while still being respectful.

For larger gatherings and more formal settings, land acknowledgements can expand in scope, include a personal story of your own that ties it to the land acknowledgement, and can even actively engage the meeting or gathering participants in different ways – go with your gut instinct, with what you feel comfortable doing, and budget appropriate time to do the research, and craft your land acknowledgement so that it comes off personalized (not a generic statement)

Roundtable Introductions

By leading a meeting or gathering with roundtable, group introductions, what this helps to do is personalize the session. You could be delivering a project update or your first community information session as part of a junior mining exploration company, working with the identified First Nation that the Ministry shared with you. This community is owed a duty to consult, which was fulfilled by ministry representatives. You may need to fly into this community to begin your exploration activities and start planning a drilling program.

Depending on the engagement strategy and approach taken, you may find yourself presenting to the community. Sometimes initial meetings in a community can be emotional, and there may be venting by community members if the project is perceived to be controversial. By personalizing the meeting with individual roundtable introductions, it can help cool the room down, and if your project is known to be problematic and divisive in the community it will be harder for individuals to dehumanize you (which can make it easier for them to discredit or disparage your reputation).

They will see you as a human being, and you'll also have the names of people who are particularly vocal and adversarial. This is your first chance to start relationship and trust building – both critical. Make the most of every opportunity. Garrett's direct personal experiences were shared with the group.

Chief and council may ask you how the meeting went and may deem it appropriate to provide more information to you on any critical voices of note. This information may come in very handy years down the road, as we will discuss throughout the course.

A few key lessons learned over the years to start the course and provide some context:

- Build personal relationships before business relationships. Make time to slow things down and talk.
- There's a lot of history that still affects many of the communities to this day. There's a lack of trust for government and industry.

- There is a general lack of capacity in the band office with most first nation communities, but not all. Many community members with education and skills leave for a better life with more opportunities.
- There are previous historical events that have taken place that result in First Nation communities simply not trusting government or industry, or any outsider.
- Recent changes in the global and Canadian economies, federal and provincial legislation has resulted in some FN's feeling threatened, disrespected, and so they are very defensive and the relationship can feel adversarial even when you feel you've done nothing wrong.

Slide 3: Introduction to Indigenous Culture – Indigenous Worldviews

Indigenous Worldviews: A Comprehensive Understanding

Indigenous worldviews offer holistic perspectives that integrate spirituality, ecology, community, and individual well-being in ways that differ fundamentally from Western ideas. These worldviews have existed for thousands of years with Indigenous peoples all over the world. While each Indigenous culture has its own unique perspectives, there are common threads that distinguish Indigenous worldviews from dominant Western approaches.

Core Principles of Indigenous Worldviews

Connection to Land and Place

At the heart of Indigenous worldviews is a deep connection to the Earth and a theme of everything being interconnected. This relationship encompasses several key aspects.

Land as Identity: Indigenous identity is intrinsically tied to specific places where people have lived since time immemorial

Reciprocal Relationship: The relationship with land is one of mutual care “we look after the land, and it looks after us”

Land can be sacred: Land holds spiritual significance, containing the places where stories, ceremonies, and ancestral connections reside

Interconnectedness: All beings are understood to be connected with one another

Balance: Maintaining harmony between all elements of existence is central to Indigenous thinking, recognizing that disruption in one area affects the whole system

Indigenous worldviews are diverse, but there are common themes like the principles of relationship, reciprocity, and connection to land. Indigenous worldviews position humans as caretakers rather than owners of Earth's resources. This stewardship approach includes a sophisticated understanding of local ecosystems developed over millennia, methods of living that ensure resources remain available for future generations and considering the interconnections between all elements of an ecosystem.

Indigenous concepts of time differ fundamentally from Western linear time: time follows natural cycles rather than mechanical measurements, the past continues to shape the present, and the present shapes the past, time follows natural, event-specific patterns rather than clock time.

Note: Garrett discussed his own experiences traveling and working in many remote First Nations and the various socioeconomic issues and challenges with addictions, suicide, all kinds of abuse, and ongoing after-effects of many community members being taken away to the residential schools that resulted in a loss of language and culture (among other things). It's not wise to assume any Indigenous community or individual is fully aware of the concepts covered in these slides.

Slide 4: Introduction to Indigenous Culture – Indigenous Worldviews

(continuing from last slide)

Spiritual Understanding

Indigenous spirituality typically includes:

Animism: Recognition that all beings possess spirit or consciousness

Sacred Relationships: Spiritual connections with animals, plants, land, and ancestors

Ceremony and Ritual: Practices that maintain relationships with the spiritual world

Gratitude and Humility: Understanding humans as part of, not separate from, nature

Oral storytelling is used as a way to pass the culture down to future generations and have been recognized in court when a community was making assertions about their connection to the land or traditions.

It is important to note that there is a lack of traditional cultural awareness, understanding, and Indigenous identity in many First Nation communities today, especially with the youth.

This Indigenous world view is the traditional historical or academic understanding, but not necessarily true today in First Nation communities that are struggling with addictions, chronic lack of funding for social services, housing, healthcare, infrastructure etc.

Slide 5: The 8 Grandfather Teachings of Treaty 3

Guiding Anishinaabe Principles for a Good Life

These teachings are central to Anishinaabe identity, providing a moral and spiritual framework for living with integrity, compassion, and balance. Treaty 3 includes eight core values; each linked to an animal or element.

Garrett learned these from the communities in Treaty 3 that he worked with, and specifically his friend, the great Elder Fred Kelly.

Respect – Buffalo:

Honouring all of creation, sharing, and treating others as you wish to be treated.

Love – Eagle:

Unconditional love for all beings, strength, and the ability to see all paths.

Wisdom – Beaver:

Cherishing knowledge and vision.

Bravery – Bear:

Facing challenges with integrity and a strong heart.

Honesty – Raven:

Integrity, speaking truthfully, and living with virtue.

Humility – Wolf:

Knowing your sacred place, living selflessly, and not being arrogant.

Truth – Turtle:

Living with sincerity, authenticity, and guiding your life by truth.

Forgiveness – Rock:

A unique Treaty 3 teaching, representing healing, carrying history, and moving forward.

The teachings are interconnected; you cannot have one without the others, as they form a complete way of life. They provide a moral and spiritual framework for Anishinaabe people, helping to guide thoughts, decisions, and actions. These teachings inform community laws, relationships, and stewardship of the land.

The eighth Grandfather teaching of Forgiveness is unique to the Treaty 3 Anishinaabe Territory. According to the Elders of this territory, they recognized that in Anishinaabe culture everything comes in even numbers – from the creation of life, to the seasons, to the songs of the Pow Wow. Through ceremony, the final Grandfather teaching of forgiveness was revealed, represented by the rock ("assin").

The rock carries history and ancestry, having witnessed changes in weather, people, and animals since creation. In Anishinaabe culture, rocks have the power to heal, and forgiveness has the power to heal – helping to cleanse and take away illness physically, emotionally, and mentally.

So, while many Indigenous communities follow the Seven Grandfather Teachings, Treaty 3 culture specifically recognizes Eight Grandfather Teachings, with the addition of Forgiveness as the eighth teaching.

Slide 6: Introduction to Indigenous Culture: Indigenous Worldviews

Traditional Ecological Knowledge

Indigenous communities have developed sophisticated understandings of their local environments through:

Long-term Observation: Knowledge accumulated over thousands of years of careful observation

Adaptive Management: Flexible approaches that respond to environmental changes

Sustainable Practices: Methods that ensure ecosystem health across generations

Indigenous peoples are not stakeholders—they are *Rightsholders* with inherent sovereignty and wisdom that has sustained communities for millennia. Their worldviews deserve respect, protection, and integration into our collective understanding of how to live well on this Earth.

Slide 7: Current Trends

The following is taken from the document “**Junior Mining Exploration and Prospecting in Northwestern Ontario: A Distributive Politics Analysis**” in the Industry Intelligence section from ugrayconsulting.com. Written by Garrett Ugray, based on the distributive politics model he learned in economics at Lakehead University. The actual document has all the sources cited in a references section at the end of the document.

“The junior mining sector in Northwestern Ontario has experienced unprecedented growth since 2020, with over 30,000 active mining claims registered in the Ring of Fire region alone—a 66% increase over three years. This exploration boom has been fueled by the Ontario government’s \$10 million Ontario Junior Exploration Program (OJEP), which provides up to \$215,000 per project to support early-stage mineral exploration, particularly for critical minerals essential to electric vehicle batteries and renewable energy infrastructure.

However, this rapid expansion of junior mining activities along with other market forces such as the growing global demand for critical minerals, a declining Canadian economy, and resultant changes in federal and provincial legislation to reduce infrastructure and mining permitting and approvals has generated significant nonmarket challenges that threatens to impede development. The region’s complex web of stakeholder interests—including Indigenous communities asserting traditional territorial rights, environmental groups concerned about ecosystem preservation, and government institutions balancing economic development with constitutional obligations—has created a contentious political environment that junior mining companies must navigate to advance their projects. Many Indigenous communities and leaders feel threatened by the changing regulatory environment and feel pressure from the private sector and government to open up their traditional territories to development faster than they feel comfortable with.

One primary issue confronting junior mining companies in Northwestern Ontario is the systematic opposition from Indigenous communities challenging the province’s free entry mining system and demanding meaningful consultation before exploration activities commence. This opposition has manifested through multiple legal challenges, cease-and-desist orders, and threats of physical blockades. Although the provincial Crown may fulfill the duty to consult under Section 35 of the Constitution Act, 1982, for early exploration and advanced exploration, it does not necessarily correlate to the junior mining company having social license to conduct those early and advanced exploration mining activities.

The free entry mining system, enshrined in Ontario's Mining Act, allows prospectors and companies to stake claims online without prior consultation with Indigenous communities whose traditional territories may be affected. Seven First Nations, including Grassy Narrows, Apitipi Anicinapek Nation, and Kitchenuhmaykoosib Inninuwug, have launched constitutional challenges arguing this system violates their treaty rights and the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples (UNDRIP) (which Ontario does not recognize).

"Companies are staking, or recording, dozens of claims per day on our traditional territory. No notice, no engagement, no addressing of our concerns at all. We're told only after the claims are registered, when it's too late," stated Chief June Black of Apitipi Anicinapek Nation."

The legal challenges seek court orders declaring specific provisions of the Mining Act unconstitutional and demanding replacement with a system requiring free, prior, and informed consent from Indigenous communities.

So that's the picture in the top left corner, with a lawyer representing those communities. That legal challenge has a near zero probability of being successful. But they feel they have no other options.

Slide 8: Practical Engagement Strategies - Research and Preparation Phase

No additional notes to add. A reminder that this is only scratching the surface.

Slide 9: Practical Engagement Strategies – Trust and Relationship Building

No additional notes to add. A reminder that this is only scratching the surface.

Slide 10: Practical Engagement Strategies – Consensus Building

There was a general discussion about consensus in the class.

Example given where majority of individuals vote in favour of a specific action, with minority of individuals voting against – the consensus would be to move forward.

Garrett discussed his work with Dr. Mike Brown from the [Consensus Building Institute](#) and the concept of starting with one idea, with one stakeholder or Rightsholder and starting there. Once agreement is reached with the first community in the middle, begin moving outward in concentric circles to the next community/communities to seek agreement on that one item (like ripples in water moving outward in concentric circles).

Consensus building is one strategic engagement framework or methodology that can help simplify very complex issues. Start with one key idea to seek agreement on, with one key community, and then move out from there like a ripple effect. There may be a long list of other ideas to seek agreement on.

A reminder that this is only scratching the surface.

Slide 11: Practical Engagement Strategies - Early Engagement to Manage Risk

No additional notes to add. A reminder that this is only scratching the surface.

Slide 12: Practical Engagement Strategies - Early Engagement to Manage Risk

References in speakers notes from the slide

1. International Council on Mining & Metals (ICMM), "Good Practice Guide: Indigenous Peoples and Mining (2nd edition)," 2024.

2. Deloitte, "Establishing a new paradigm for Indigenous relations," Energy, Resources & Industrials, 2024.

3. Justice & Corporate Accountability Project, "Social Conflict and Indigenous Consent in Mining: A primer on CSR, ESG and social disclosures to investors," December 2024.

4. Mining Association of Canada, "TSM Indigenous and Community Relationships Protocol," 2020.

Slide 13: Scenario I - Seemingly low risk & simple

Garrett's immediate response:

"I apologize for that, I didn't know you would be out here right now. Can I get your name and contact information so that I can time my prospecting activities so as not to overlap with your hunting and trapping? I can also follow up with your community to start a dialogue in case there are others out in the area hunting and enjoying their inherent rights."

Garrett's next 3 moves:

- 1) Get trapper's contact information, or first and last name at least.
- 2) Exit the area the same way I walked in – there could be other people actively hunting.
- 3) Contact the local band office and introduce myself, state my intentions to continue prospecting, and begin a dialogue.

Slide 14: Scenario II - Moderate risk and complexity

Garrett's immediate response:

Take some time to step back and fully assess the situation; goal is to keep some sort of lifeline with the community, no need to rush hurriedly into agreeing to disagree, and having one or both parties walk away.

The negotiations and the relationship are sensitive, and it's important to plan next moves carefully

Garrett's next 3 moves:

1) Need some sort of backdoor channel of communication into the community to get around the lawyers and consultants. This is where personal community contacts can be helpful as it is often these backdoor conversations that lead to breakthroughs: I would reach out to my personal network of contacts to see if anyone can help establish comms – I have used an external third-party consultant that reaches out directly to leadership.

2) Research and prepare my pitch – that what the community is demanding for is unreasonable, and prepare to explain why: (this comes from Garrett's direct experience, likely similar for other projects)

- a. We can only commit to funds that are proportional to the nature of the specific project and that are feasible for the project to sustain.
- b. We are still at the early stages of mineral exploration, and we need to find a balanced approach to our commitments.
- c. Early exploration is a highly speculative, which requires significant investment and expenditure but produces no direct revenue stream to the company. As a result, arrangements at this stage should be scaled in proportion to the nature of our project. If we made commitments that extend beyond the capacity of our project to support them, we may jeopardize investment in our project later on.
- d. If the community wants any chances at potential job opportunities and economic development, we must find shared interests that are feasible and realistic to finance.
- e. Prepare by Reviewing "*Proportionality of agreements throughout the mining sequence*" figure from MNDM's "*Statement on community-proponent agreements*" and review <https://www.ontario.ca/page/mining-sequence>

i. All included in Appendix 2

Explain to the community that what they are asking for is unreasonable, and jeopardizes the project and any potential benefits for the community.

Prepare list of commitments my company can make that build trust and a relationship with the community that doesn't cost money (or is very cheap): elder advisory committee, youth employment program in the summer, start using more elders to help out at meetings, using local community members to help provide meals for meetings, commit to incorporating TK into your project, hire a community member to act as a liaison, commit to youth engagement, start incorporating local governance systems as best you can, commit to drafting a reconciliation policy statement made with the community for your website and CEO support etc. etc. A reminder that this is only scratching the surface.

3) Reach out to community member personal contact, somehow, and prepare for backdoor meeting to at least have my message delivered.

Slide 15: Scenario III – Strategic Issues & Reputation Management, Risk Mitigation and Scenario Planning

No additional notes to add. Garrett shared his direct personal experiences with the group and what happened. Course was running 45 minutes late. Please reach out directly to Garrett for his notes as they will not be shared broadly or posted to his website.

Slide 16: Health Break and General Q & A

No additional notes to add. Course ran out of time.

Appendix I: Treaties in Northwestern Ontario

Tribal Councils can be helpful when planning and researching community outreach. During the course, a request was made to list the treaties in northwestern Ontario, the Tribal Councils, and the communities that are affiliated with them.

Overview

Northwestern Ontario is covered by several historic treaties between First Nations and the Crown. This list includes all treaties affecting the region and their corresponding political territorial organizations, resource and tribal councils and member communities.

Treaty 3 (1873)

Signed: October 3, 1873

Territory: Northwestern Ontario and eastern Manitoba (55,000 square miles)

Signatory Nations: Ojibwe (Anishinaabe)

Population: Approximately 25,000 members

Political Territorial Organization

Grand Council Treaty #3

Website: <https://gct3.ca/>

[Interactive map linked here](#) showing all 28 communities

Tribal and Resource Advisory Councils in Treaty 3

Many but not all Treaty 3 First Nations are organized under the following Tribal Councils: **AKRC, Bimose Tribal Council, Pwi-Di-Goo-Zing Ne-Yaa-Zhing Advisory Services, Kenora Chiefs Advisory (KCA).**

1. Anishinaabeg of Kabapikotawangag Resource Council (AKRC)

Website: <https://www.akrc.on.ca/>

Member Communities:

- Animakee Wa Zhing 37
- Big Grassy River
- Northwest Angle 33
- Ojibways of Onigaming
- Wauzhushk Onigum

2. Bimose Tribal Council

Website: <https://www.bimose.ca/>

Member Communities:

- Eagle Lake First Nation
- Iskatewizaagegan #39 Independent First Nation
- Lac des Mille Lacs First Nation
- Niisaachewan Anishinaabe Nation
- Shoal Lake #40 First Nation
- Washagamis Bay First Nation
- Wabauskang First Nation
- Wabigoon Lake Ojibway Nation
- Wabaseemoong Independent Nations
- Asubpeeschoseewagong Netum Anishinabek

3. Pwi-Di-Goo-Zing Ne-Yaa-Zhing Advisory Services

Website: <https://advisoryservices.ca/>

Member Communities:

- Couchiching First Nation
- Gakijiwanong Anishinaabe Nation
- Mitaanjigamiing First Nation
- Naicatchewenin First Nation
- Nigigoonsiminikaaning First Nation
- Rainy River First Nations
- Seine River First Nation

4. Kenora Chiefs Advisory (KCA)

Website: <https://www.kenorachiefs.org/>

Member Communities:

- Asubpeeschoseewagong First Nation (Grassy Narrows)
- Naotkamegwanning First Nation (Whitefish Bay)
- Niisaachewan Anishinaabe Nation

- Northwest Angle #33
- Washagamis Bay
- Shoal Lake #40
- Wabaseemoong Independent Nations (Whitedog)
- Wauzhushk Onigum Nation (Rat Portage)

Other Treaty 3 First Nations

- Buffalo Point First Nation (Manitoba)
- Lac Seul First Nation (member of Independent First Nations Alliance)
- Sagkeeng First Nation (Manitoba, Fort Alexander)
- Lac Des Mille Lacs First Nation
- Ojibway Nation of Saugeen

Treaty 5 (1875)

Signed: 1875 – 1876

Territory: Present-day central and northern Manitoba, parts of Saskatchewan and Ontario

Signatory Nations: Ojibwa, Swampy Cree of Lake Winnipeg

Treaty 5 Sovereign Nations map.

Ontario First Nation Communities in Treaty 5:

- Koocheching First Nation
- Kee-Way-Win
- North Spirit Lake First Nation
- Sandy Lake First Nation
- Deer Lake First Nation
- Poplar Hill
- Pikangikum

Treaty 9 (1905-1906)

Signed: 1905–1906 (with adhesions in 1929–1930)

Territory: Northern Ontario (approximately 90,000 square miles)

Signatory Nations: Ojibwe, Cree, Algonquin

Political Territorial Organization

Nishnawbe Aski Nation (NAN)

- Website: <https://www.nan.ca/>
- Treaty Website: <https://nantreaties.ca/>
- Full list of all First Nations with affiliated Tribal Council on a map can be viewed here.

Robinson-Superior Treaty (1850)

Signed: September 7, 1850

Territory: North shore of Lake Superior and interior areas

Signatory Nations: Ojibwa

Many Robinson-Superior Treaty First Nations have their own individual governance structures or are part of other regional organizations, may not have signed a treaty, and may not have ceded or surrendered their lands and maintain unextinguished Aboriginal title to their territories. Always best to check the community's website.

Political Territorial Organization: Union of Ontario Indians (Anishinabek Nation)

Website: <https://anishinabek.ca/>

Represents: Many Robinson-Superior Treaty First Nations

Tribal Councils and member communities

1. Nookiiwin Tribal Council

Website <https://www.nookiiwin.com/>

Member communities:

- Animbiigoo Zaagiigan Anishinaabek (Lake Nipigon Ojibway)
- Biinjitiwaabik Zaaging Anishinaabek (Rocky Bay First Nation)
- Bingwi Neyaashi Anishinaabek (Sandpoint First Nation)
- Netmizaaggamig Nishnaabeg (Pic Mobert First Nation, unceded)
- Fort William First Nation

2. Independent First Nations Alliance (IFNA)

Website <https://www.ifna.ca/>

Member community in Robinson Superior Treaty:

- Whitesand First Nation

3. Matawa First Nations Management

Website <https://www.matawa.on.ca/>

Member community:

- Long Lake #58 First Nation (lies within boundaries of Robinson–Superior Treaty of 1850, never signed a treaty with the Crown)

DRAFT

Appendix 2: Supplementary Information from Ministry of Energy and Mines

The decision was made to deliberately leave out any slides specifically relating to the Crown's duty to consult and or accommodate, as appropriate, as that is generally fulfilled by the Ministry of Energy and Mines for mining exploration. However, some people were curious and had many questions regarding the duty to consult, how the Crown makes these assessments, identifies communities as being owed a duty to consult, and there was significant discussion about these topics. All good things.

The documents below were discussed during the course and there were requests to list them here as part of this supplementary course package.

<https://www.ontario.ca/page/statement-community-proponent-agreements>

This statement updated in October of 2025 by the Ministry would be helpful to review to develop messaging before going into negotiations or early discussions with a community.

"Negotiations, at any stage, can be challenging and multi-faceted and depend on the communities, proponents, and projects involved. Regardless of specific circumstances, open and transparent communication about a project (such as how it is financed, what is feasible and what is not, etc.) can go a long way to advancing discussions, managing expectations and achieving a respectful working relationship. Being realistic and practical about the commitments appropriate at and proportional to different project stages is also critical."

<https://www.ontario.ca/page/mining-sequence>

https://www.ontario.ca/page/consultation-framework-implementing-duty-consult-aboriginal-communities-mineral-exploration#Consultation_spectrum